

# Phishing Email Analysis

## Objective

The objective of this task is to analyze sample safe phishing emails and identify suspicious indicators such as sender address, links, urgency, and attachments.

## Phishing Indicator Checklist

### 1. Sender Address

Check whether the sender's email address belongs to the expected organization. Look for misspelled, unusual, or suspicious domain names.

### 2. Suspicious Links

Check the destination of links before clicking them. Be cautious if the URL does not match the organization mentioned in the email.

### 3. Urgency

Be careful with emails that pressure you to act immediately, verify an account, make a payment, or avoid account suspension.

### 4. Attachments

Treat unexpected attachments with caution. Do not open attachments unless their source and purpose have been verified.

### 5. Requests for Sensitive Information

Be cautious if an email asks for passwords, payment information, verification codes, or other sensitive information.

### 6. Email Content

Look for spelling mistakes, unusual formatting, inconsistent branding, or requests that do not match normal communication patterns.

### 7. Sender and Message Verification

If an email appears suspicious, verify the request through the organization's official website or another trusted communication channel instead of using information provided in the email.

## Sample Email Analysis

### Sample Email 1

Subject: Urgent: Your Account Will Be Suspended

From: security@paypa1-support.com

Dear Customer,

Your account will be suspended within 24 hours unless you verify your information immediately. Please click the link below to confirm your account:

<https://example.com/account-verification>

Thank you,  
Account Security Team

Analysis:

Sender Address:

The sender address is suspicious because the domain "paypa1-support.com" does not appear to be an official organization domain.

Link:

The link should be treated with caution because the destination does not match the organization mentioned in the email.

Urgency:

The email creates urgency by threatening account suspension within 24 hours.

Attachment:

No attachment is present.

Overall Assessment:

The email contains multiple phishing indicators, including a suspicious sender address, a potentially misleading link, and an urgent request.

## **Sample Email 2**

Subject: Your Invoice Is Ready – Payment Required

From: billing@company-payment-example.com

Dear Customer,

Your latest invoice is attached to this email. Please review the invoice and complete the payment as soon as possible to avoid additional charges.

Please open the attached invoice and follow the payment instructions provided.

Regards,  
Billing Department

Analysis:

Sender Address:

The sender address should be verified because the domain does not clearly match a known organization.

Link:

No direct link is included in this sample email.

Urgency:

The email creates pressure by asking the recipient to make a payment quickly to avoid additional charges.

Attachment:

The email contains an unexpected invoice attachment. The attachment should not be opened until the sender and purpose of the file have been verified.

Overall Assessment:

The email should be treated as suspicious because it contains an unexpected payment request, urgency, and an attachment from an unverified sender.

## **Conclusion**

Phishing emails can contain several warning signs that help identify suspicious messages. Important indicators include suspicious sender addresses, misleading links, urgent requests, unexpected attachments, requests for sensitive information, and unusual email content.

By checking these indicators before clicking links, opening attachments, or sharing information, users can reduce the risk of falling victim to phishing attacks.

## **Interview Questions**

### **1. How do you identify phishing?**

I identify phishing by checking the sender's email address, suspicious links, unusual requests, urgency, unexpected attachments, and requests for sensitive information. I also look for spelling errors, domain inconsistencies, and unusual email behavior.

### **2. What is spear phishing?**

Spear phishing is a targeted phishing attack directed at a specific person or organization. The attacker usually uses personalized information to make the message appear more trustworthy.

### **3. Why are shortened links risky?**

Shortened links can hide the actual destination URL. This makes it harder to verify where the link will lead and can increase the risk of being redirected to a malicious or fraudulent website.